computer remotely and wiped the cables, though it would never be clear whether she had copied them or not. The *Guardian* reporter's argument is that she was shopping them around. I can't tell you how many times we have come across people – people who think of themselves as campaigners – behaving like stock exchange bullies when it comes to a commodity they are interested in. You can hear the snap of their red braces as they go in for the kill. Although we had sorted out the *Independent* thing, the *Guardian*'s senior reporter said it was all very threatening and that a 'rogue' copy of the data might be out there. He wanted to rush towards publication. I told him we weren't ready and we had a written agreement. He went off in a fluster and we didn't hear from him.

It became clear later that he had already copied the material for the *New York Times*. They were moving towards publication with no regard for any of the important issues – matters of life and death – that stood behind the documents. Like greedy, reckless, damn-them-all bandits, they were going to shoot up the town no matter who was standing in the way. The *Guardian*'s reporter had behaved cravenly and lawlessly, and was quite happy to please his newspaper, and his heroes across the Atlantic, while dumping the whole thing on our heads without warning. There isn't a student journalist who would behave in so unprincipled a way, having no care for the story itself, or the people who supplied it, before the onrush of his own dirty plan to stab us in the back. Given how poorly the *New York Times* had supported the earlier leaks, and given how hostile they had become to me, it just didn't make any sense for us to collaborate further with them. It was our work, after all. But the *Guardian* didn't care about any of that: they wanted the *New York Times* to help shore up their own defences, and WikiLeaks could go and hang itself from the nearest tree.

We simply had to have some time. It was deeper than any of them could understand, in their juvenile deadline-mania, but we had to have time to prepare for this. I called Rusbridger and he agreed I should come in for talks. The *New York Times* involvement – which was illegal, remember, given my signed agreement with Rusbridger – was not something anyone would yet admit to, but I came into the *Guardian* offices in high dudgeon. I knew they were double-crossing us, without even having the balls to say that is what they were doing. We came into the building with my lawyer, Mark Stephens, and, as chance would have it, we came face to face with the senior news reporter beside the stairs.